

Do you ever talk about sex on the phone or the Internet?



All figures in per cent. Rest, Don't know/Won't say

Did you have sex with your wife when she was pregnant?

Initially during first trimester	33
During the second trimester	25
All the time	23

All figures in per cent. Rest, Don't know/Won't say

BABY BLUES

Thirty-four per cent women feel the frequency of sex declines after children. In 2003, 22% women felt poor body image reduced their sexual pleasure. More women connect the body with healthy sexuality now.

Working women are more sexually liberated. Do you agree?

		MALE	FEMALE
Agree to a large extent	31	35	24
Agree somewhat	40	39	41
Disagree somewhat	12	10	14
Disagree to a large extent	8	6	11

YES TO SEX

Men always thought sex was important—76% of them in 2004 believed in equal pleasure for their wives in bed. Women too agree now—the percentage who feel sex is important has gone up from 23% in 2003 to 33% in 2007.

All figures in per cent. Rest, Don't know/Won't say

were extravagantly detailed. By contrast, he completely forgot to tabulate the information from his three questions on birth control. The first was the "Living apart of Husband and Wife for some time as a Routine Practice" which, according to Ghurye, was an aspect of "the Hindu way of living". The second, on which he lavished much attention, was the prevalence of "multiple coitus". More than 50 per cent of those who answered the latter question admitted to

(boasted of) multiple coitus, in the early days of marriage or even later, some 12 per cent claiming coitus between two and six times a night and, in one exaggerated case, eight times. Here, once again, the professor was confronted with theoretical, methodological, and statistical dilemmas. Do overall estimates of frequency of coitus include counts of multiple coitus? Apparently not. Is there a seasonal variation in sexual frequency and multiple coitus? Maybe yes, the

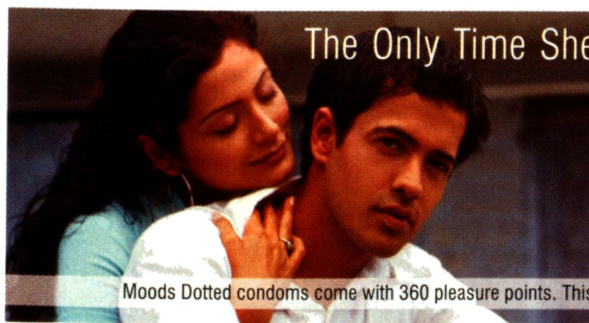
winter being more conducive than summer, according to at least one informant. Is the education level or occupation of the practitioners of multiple coitus at all significant? It doesn't seem so. And, most important of all, do those who regularly engage in multiple coitus routinely have sex on more days in the month? Indeed they do.

Actually, it seems that Ghurye's two preoccupations—the "living apart of husband and wife for some time as routine practice"

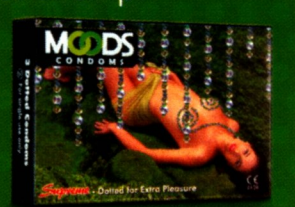
and the phenomenon of multiple coitus—were somehow intimately related. "Sexologists", he claimed, "would seem to agree that temporary separation as a periodic practice is conducive to married happiness." In fact, a large number of his subjects who had been separated from their wives for varying periods noted a positive change in the frequency of coitus. Many of them attested, in graphic detail, to "gushing" desire and multiple coitus, "even during daytime". In a particularly analytical self-reflection, one subject—"a pleader" who had moved to a separate bed from his wife's—testified to the reduced frequency but a distinctly greater pleasure of intercourse that was no longer on this account just a "routine affair".

For whatever reason, on which one can only speculate here, neither the benefits of temporary separation nor the preoccupation with multiple coitus find a place in the 2007 INDIA TODAY survey of conjugal sexuality. All of which leads one to conclude either that times have really changed, 70 years on; that the good professor had his quirks; or that maximum togetherness is not, after all, the secret of marital bliss.

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